

:TYPES OF SENTENCES BY STRUCTURE

1. What Do We Mean by "Sentence Structure"?

Sentence structure is the way clauses are combined to form a sentence. A *clause* is a group of words with a subject and a verb.

There are two kinds of clauses:

1. *Main/Independent Clause*: Can stand alone as a complete sentence. _Example_: The boy ran↓.

2. *Subordinate/Dependent Clause*: Cannot stand alone. It needs a main clause. _Example_: because he was late↑.

The number and type of clauses in a sentence determine its structure.

2. Four Types of Sentences by Structure

A. Simple Sentence

Definition: Contains only *one main clause* and no subordinate clause. It expresses one complete idea.

Features:

- Only one subject + verb combination.
- May have compound subjects or verbs, but still one clause.

Examples:

1. Abuja is the capital of Nigeria↓.
2. My brother and sister attend the same school↓. _Compound subject_
3. The baby laughed and clapped↓. _Compound verb_

B. Compound Sentence

Definition: Contains *two or more main clauses* joined by coordinating conjunctions or a semicolon. No subordinate clause.

Common Coordinating Conjunctions: _for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so_ (FANBOYS)

Examples:

1. I wanted to go out, *but* it started raining↓.

2. She studies hard, *so* she passes her exams↓.

3. He can play football *or* he can watch the match↓.

Note: Each part before and after the conjunction can stand alone as a sentence.

C. Complex Sentence

Definition: Contains *one main clause* and *one or more subordinate clauses*.

Subordinate clauses begin with subordinating conjunctions or relative pronouns like: _because, although, since, when, while, if, after, before, who, which, that_.

Examples:

1. *When the teacher entered*, the class became quiet↓.

- Main: _the class became quiet_

- Subordinate: _When the teacher entered_

2. We will not travel *if it rains*↓.

3. The girl *who won the prize* is my cousin↓.

D. Compound-Complex Sentence

Definition: Contains *two or more main clauses* and *at least one subordinate clause*. It is a combination of compound and complex.

Examples:

1. *Although he was tired*, he finished his homework, *and* he submitted it↓.

- Subordinate: _Although he was tired_

- Main 1: _he finished his homework_

- Main 2: _he submitted it_

2. I called you, *but* you did not answer *because your phone was off*↓.

4. How to Identify Sentence Structure

1. *Find the verbs* → each verb likely signals a clause.

2. *Underline each clause*. Ask: Can it stand alone?

3. *Count main and subordinate clauses*.

4. *Check the joining words* to confirm the type.

5. Class Work

Identify the structure of these sentences:

1. The sun is shining↓.

2. We missed the bus, so we walked to school↓.

3. After she finished eating, she washed her plate↓.

4. Although the test was hard, I passed it and my sister failed it↓.

Answers: 1. Simple 2. Compound 3. Complex 4. Compound-Complex

6. Assignment

1. Write one example each of the four types of sentences.